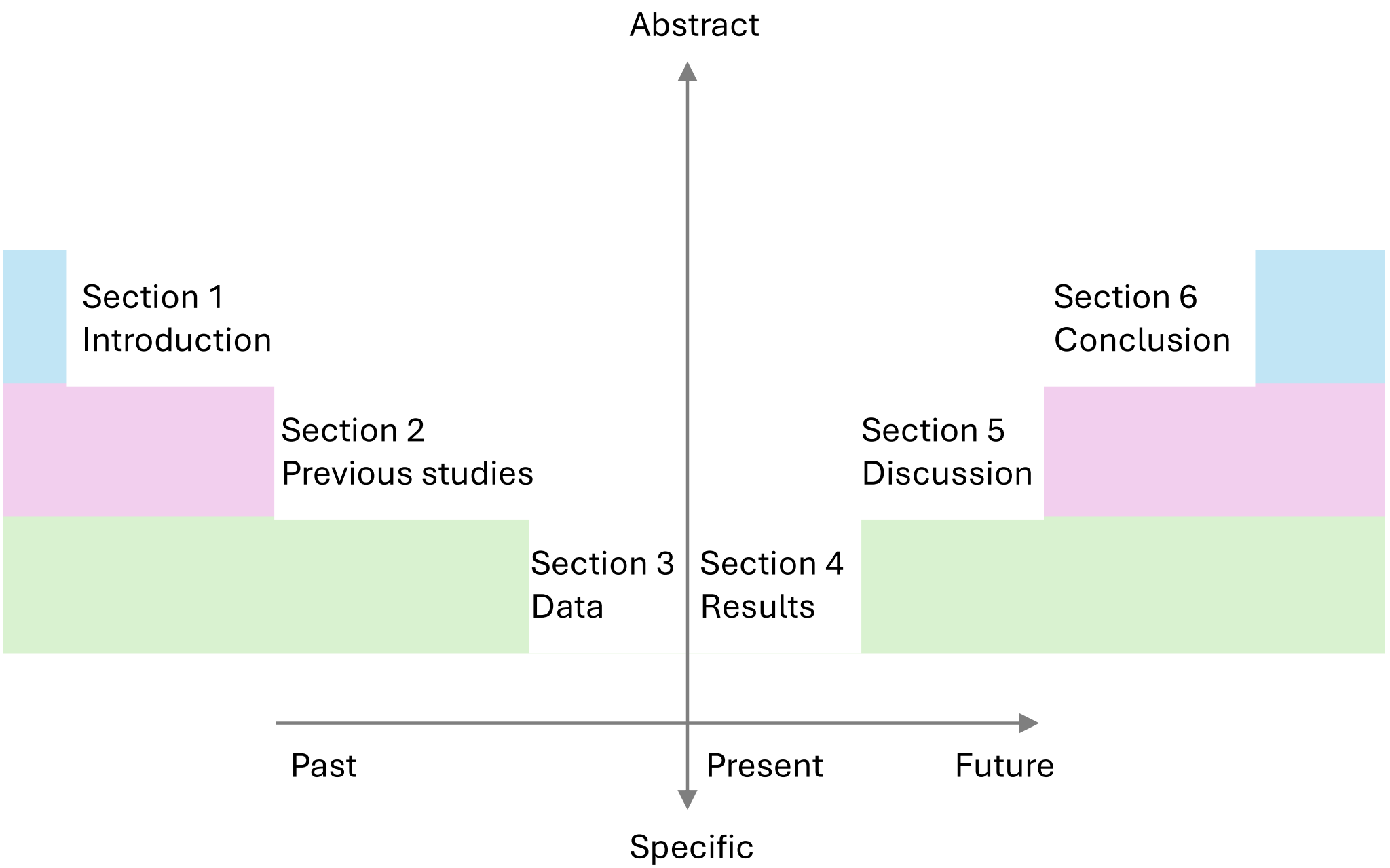
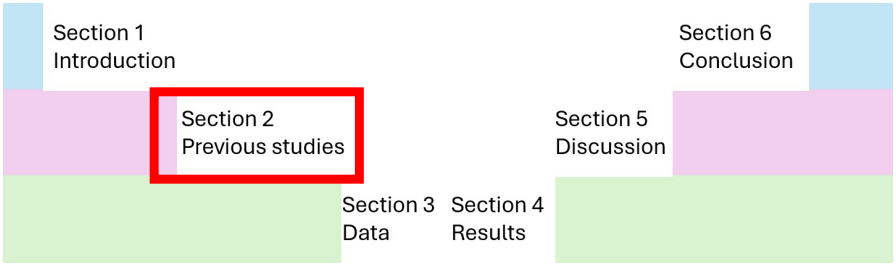
Class 3

Academic reading 2: Previous literature

Corpus research 2: Tagging


Abstract
Section 1
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II Previous analyses of 'passive' unaccusatives

Let us now turn to the five major accounts of the 'passive' unaccusative structure listed in (4). It should be noted that while some of these are strongly argued for by their proponents, others are simply suggested as possibilities or even merely hinted at in passing remarks. Also, it is also not uncommon to find a single researcher espousing multiple accounts and/or variation(s) thereof.

1 L1 transfer of a tense/aspect auxiliary verb + a past participle

In Richards (1973: 103–04), 'passive' unaccusative errors were considered as indications of the learner's imperfect mastery of the English tense/aspect system. This interpretation seems to be motivated by the fact that in many languages with a compound tense/aspect system, unaccusatives take a *be*-type auxiliary verb while unergatives and transitives require a *have*-type.[4] See, for instance, the following grammatical German and Dutch examples:

5)	German:	Drei Jungen three boys	sind be 3pl	am Bahnhof to the station	angekommen. arrive p.p.
6)	Dutch:	Drie jongens three boys	zijn be 3pl	op het station to the station	gearriveerd. arrive p.p.

Although the prepositional phrase 'to the station' precedes the main verb both in (5) and (6), the combination of a *be*-type auxiliary and the past participle of an unaccusative is clearly

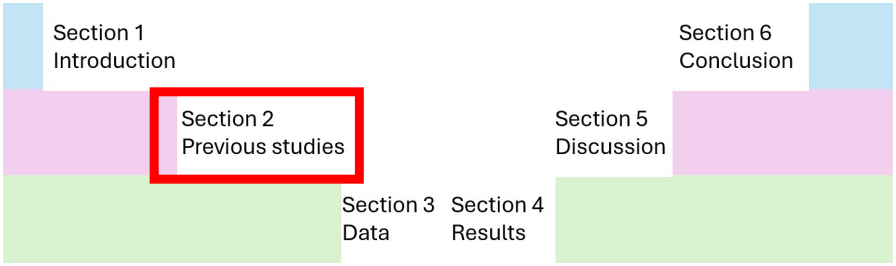
Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

Rechards (1973)

1) **Observation**
   In German, Italian, etc.
   a. unaccusative: *be*
   b. unergative/transitive: *have*



reminiscent of the typical 'passive' unaccusative error in IL English such as (7):

7) IL English: * Three boys are arrived at the station.

Furthermore, in Italian and French, the sentences (8) and (9) are not only grammatical but identical to the IL English in word order as well:

8) Italian:	Tre ragazzi three boys	sono be 3pl	arrivati arrive p.p.	alla stazione. to-the station
9) French:	Trois garçons three boys	sont be 3pl	arrivés arrive p.p.	à la gare. to the station

In light of this overwhelming resemblance, some researchers (e.g., Hubbard and Hix, 1988) have suspected that the cause of the non-target *be* + *en* structure could be the relevant morphosyntactic properties of the learner's L1, which may be carried over to their IL English. The transfer account is probably one of the first interpretations of the 'passive' unaccusative error that comes to mind for those familiar with the kind of compound tense/aspect systems discussed above. (For instance, a few examples of 'passive' unaccusatives included in my query to the *Linguist List* (7.1239.1) in the fall of 1996 generated many responses, most of which suggested L1 interference as a cause of the errors.)

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

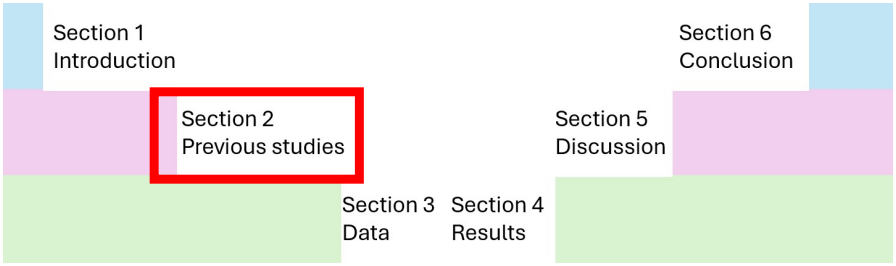
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   In German, Italian, etc.
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2) **Proposal**
   L1 grammar is carried over to their IL English.



An explanation along this line of reasoning would be quite sufficient if 'passive' unaccusative errors were produced exclusively or even predominantly by native speakers of the languages with a relevant compound tense/aspect system but rarely by those whose L1 lacks such a morphosyntactic property (compare the criterion of 'inter-L1-group heterogeneity in learners' IL performance' proposed in Jarvis, 2000). The problem is that this 'passive' unaccusative error is extremely prevalent among speakers of languages such as Chinese, Japanese and Korean,[5] none of which has a comparable compound tense/aspect system (e.g., Schachter and Hart, 1979; Zobl, 1989; Yip, 1994; 1995; Hirakawa, 1995; Shomura, 1996; Hwang, 1997; Oshita, 1997; Ju, 2000).

Consider the following examples. (CL, GEN, LOC, NOM, PASS, PAST and PFV stand for 'Classifier', 'Genitive', 'Locative', 'Nominative', 'Passive', 'Past' and 'Perfective', respectively.)

10) Chinese:

a.	San-ge	nanhaizi	dao-le	huoche zhan.	
	three-CL	male-child	arrive-PFV	train station	
b. *	San-ge	nanhaizi	bei	dao-le	huoche zhan.
	three-CL	male-child	PASS	arrive-PFV	train station

11) Japanese:

a.	San-nin-no	syoonen-ga	eki-ni	tuita.
	three-CL-GEN	boy-NOM	train station-LOC	arrive-past
b. *	San-nin-no	syoonen-ga	eki-ni	tukareta.
	three-CL-GEN	boy-NOM	train station-LOC	arrive-PASS-PAST

12) Korean:

a.	Sey-salam-uy	cheng-nyen-i	yek-ey	ilulesstta.
	three-CL-GEN	boy-NOM	train station-LOC	arrive-PAST
b. *	Sey-salam-uy	cheng-nyen-i	yek-ey	ilulecyesstta.
	three-CL-GEN	boy-NOM	train station-LOC	arrive-PASS-PAST

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

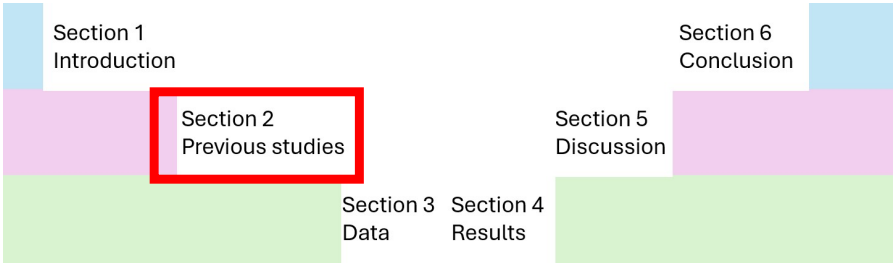
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   L1 grammar is carried over to their IL English.

3) **Limitation**
   a. **Prediction:** Overpassivization must be restricted to L1 speakers of 'be + pp' cnstr.
   b. **Observation**: Japanese etc.



Thus, a strong (or exclusive) version of the transfer account in (13) has to be rejected.

13) *Strong Version of the Transfer Account*: L1 transfer of the combination of a *be*-type auxiliary verb and a past participle is the *one and only* cause of the 'passive' unaccusative error in IL English.

The rejection of (13), however, does not necessarily mean that we must abandon the transfer account completely. Consider (14).

14) *Weak Version of the Transfer Account*: L1 transfer of the combination of a *be*-type auxiliary verb and a past participle is *one* of the causes of the 'passive' unaccusative error in IL English.

What (14) suggests is that the learner's L1 is simply one of the potential factors that may contribute to the appearance of 'passive' unaccusative errors. This weak interpretation of an L1 transfer account is still logically possible, but, if so, we may ask whether, influenced by one more potential cause, speakers of German, Dutch, Italian and French, for instance, are more susceptible to 'passive' unaccusative errors than are native speakers of Chinese, Japanese, Korean and so forth.[6] This is a question that has yet to be investigated.

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

Rechards (1973)

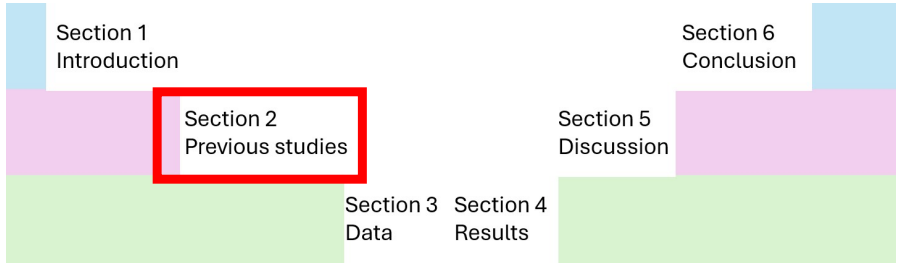
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   a. **Prediction:** Overpassivization must be restricted to L1 speakers of 'be + pp' cnstr.
   b. **Observation**: Japanese etc.

4) **Caveats**
   Weaker version of TA



2 *Overgeneralization of the English adjectival passive formation*

A second account of the 'passive' unaccusative is based on a deverbal adjective formation found in the target English. As a background for this analysis, consider the contrast between the verbal passive of (15a) and the adjectival passives of (15b)–(15c). In (15a), *furnished* has a dynamic reading while its intended readings in (15b)–(15c) are stative.

15) a. The apartment was (quickly) furnished to make it more attractive.
b. When John moved in, the apartment was (already/still) furnished.
c. John is looking for a furnished apartment.

While adjectival passives are typically derived from transitive change-of-state verbs, unaccusative verbs are also known to undergo this lexical process (Bresnan, 1982; Levin and Rappaport, 1986).

16) a. elapsed time b. a fallen leaf c. the drifted snow
d. wilted lettuce e. a collapsed tent f. vanished civilizations
(a–c from Bresnan, 1982; d–f from Levin and Rappaport, 1986)

Hubbard and Hix (1988) and Hubbard (1994) have suggested that overgeneralization of the adjectival passive formation may be a potential cause of 'passive' unaccusatives. This interpretation has one clear advantage in explaining a common characteristic shared by the majority of naturally produced 'passive' unaccusatives, namely, the fact that they appear mostly as part of what looks like a so-called 'short passive' without an agentive *by* phrase (see Oshita, 1997: Appendix B). If 'passive' unaccusatives are adjectives in the relevant IL English grammar and semantically stative, it is quite natural that they are generally not accompanied by a syntactic structure that may indicate the existence of a causative agent.

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

Rechards (1973)

Hubbard and Hix (1988)

L1 ⇨ L2

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

Hubbard and Hix (1988)

Hubbard (1994)

1) Observation

Analogy at work:

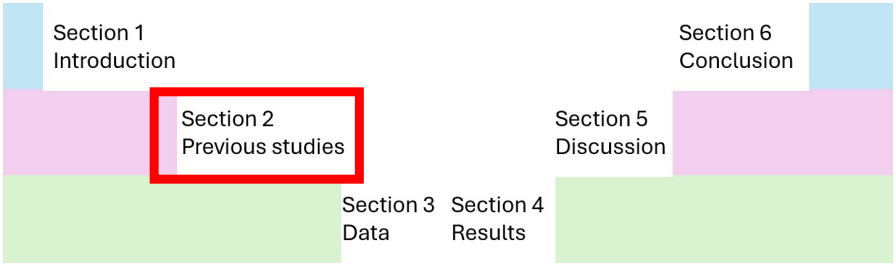
a. (i) Houses **were furnished**.
(ii) **furnished** houses

b. (i) Leaves _____.
(ii) **fallen** leaves

2) Proposal

Overgeneralization of the A-passive formation → Errors.

L2 ⇨ L2



However, there are a couple of reasons why the adjectival passive account is rather suspicious as an explanation for the 'passive' unaccusative structure. The first concerns the syntactic position in which past participles of unaccusatives appear. If they are adjectives, they are expected to be used attributively as well as predicatively. However, errors such as *died people* and *happened accidents* in the sense of 'dead people' and 'accidents that have happened' do not seem to afflict the learners with relatively advanced proficiency, who, nevertheless, appear to be particularly vulnerable to 'passive' unaccusative errors. This, incidentally, may suggest that the 'passive' unaccusative phenomenon has to be accounted for independently from the acquisition of English adjectival passives by nonnative speakers because the latter seems to exhibit a more consistent normal pattern of progress (Chuming, 1995).

The second reason to question the plausibility of the adjectival passive analysis is semantic. If past participles in the nontarget *be* + *en* are in fact adjectives, their intended meaning should be stative, rather than dynamic, since typical adjectives have property readings and specify temporary or permanent attributes of nouns (Trask, 1993; Crystal, 1997; Matthews, 1997). However, the stative readings of most published examples of 'passive' unaccusatives are not very felicitous. Consider, for instance, the plausibility (or lack thereof) of the readings expressed in (17a)–(17d), which correspond to (1a)–(1d).

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

Hubbard and Hix (1988)
Hubbard (1994)

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2) **Proposal**

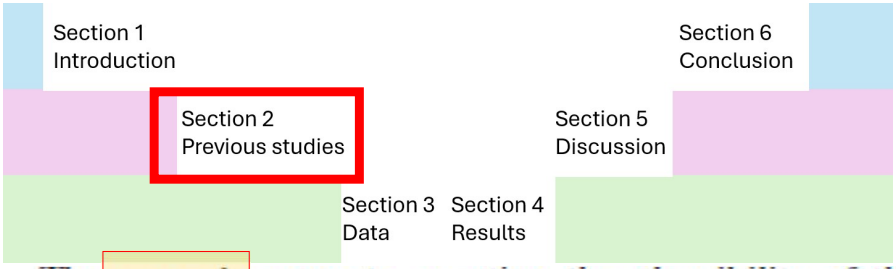
Overgeneralization of the A-passive formation → Errors.

L2 ⇨ L2

3) **Limitations**

a. Some lack the use in (ii):

   **died people*, *happened accidents*



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17) a. The most memorable experience of my life was in existence 15 years ago (as a result of its happening).
b. Most of people are in love with someone (as a result of falling in love) and get married.
c. My mother was dead (as a result of dying) when I was just a baby.
d. He was there early (as a result of arriving).

Intuitively, these readings appear to be highly improbable, if not outright wrong.

The fact that adjectives have stative meaning presents still another problem for the adjectival passive account. What compels learners to resort to this structure when the meaning of an unaccusative verb is inherently stative? Consider, for instance, (18):

18) a. * This problem is existed for many years. [=(1e)] (Hubbard, 1994)
b. * The two might have been coexisted. (Schachter and Hart, 1979)

Although some stative verbs do undergo the adjectival passive formation[7] (e.g., *know*, from which *(un)known* is derived), the adjectival passive analysis for cases like (18a)–(18b) is superfluous since 'passivization' to imply stativity is clearly redundant here.

Considering these potential problems, the adjectival passive analysis appears to be rather weak as an account of the 'passive' unaccusative phenomenon.

Section 2 Previous studies

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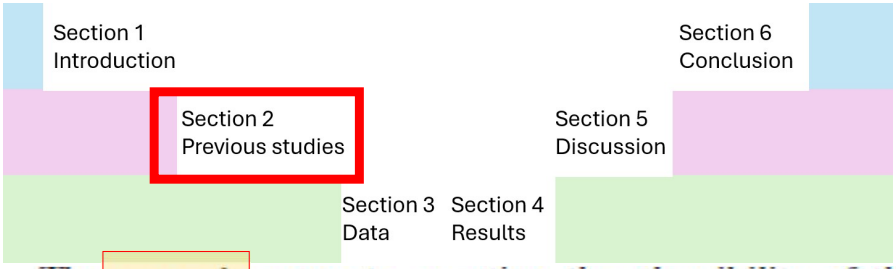
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Overgeneralization of the A-passive formation → Errors.

L2 ⇨ L2

3) Limitations

a. Some lack the use in (ii):
**died people, happened accidents*
b. Errors do not occur in a stative sentence.



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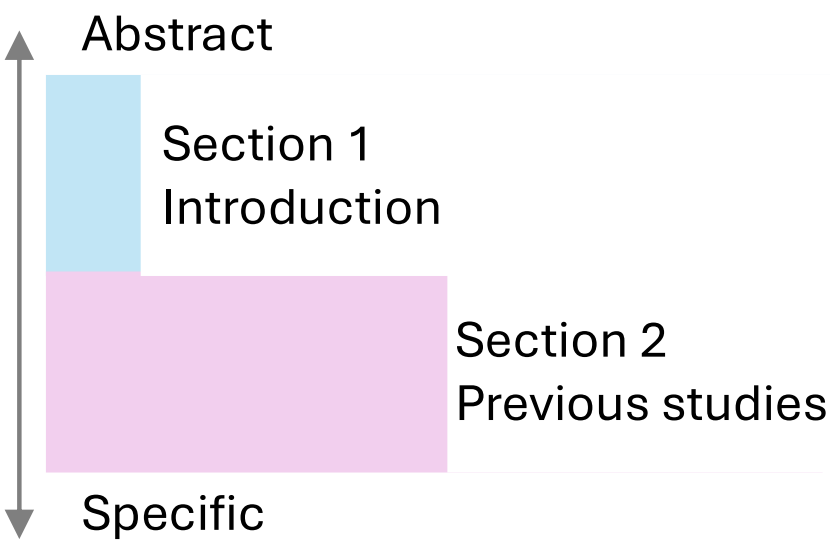
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L2 ⇨ L2

3) Limitations

a. Some lack the use in (ii):
**died people*, *happened accidents*
b. Errors do not occur in a stative sentence.
c. Errors with already stative pps.



1) Put the authors' names.
2) Key observation: How they started
3) Main idea: what they proposed
4) Limitations: remaining problems

Broader context

Immediate context

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies
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4) **Caveats**
Weaker version of TA

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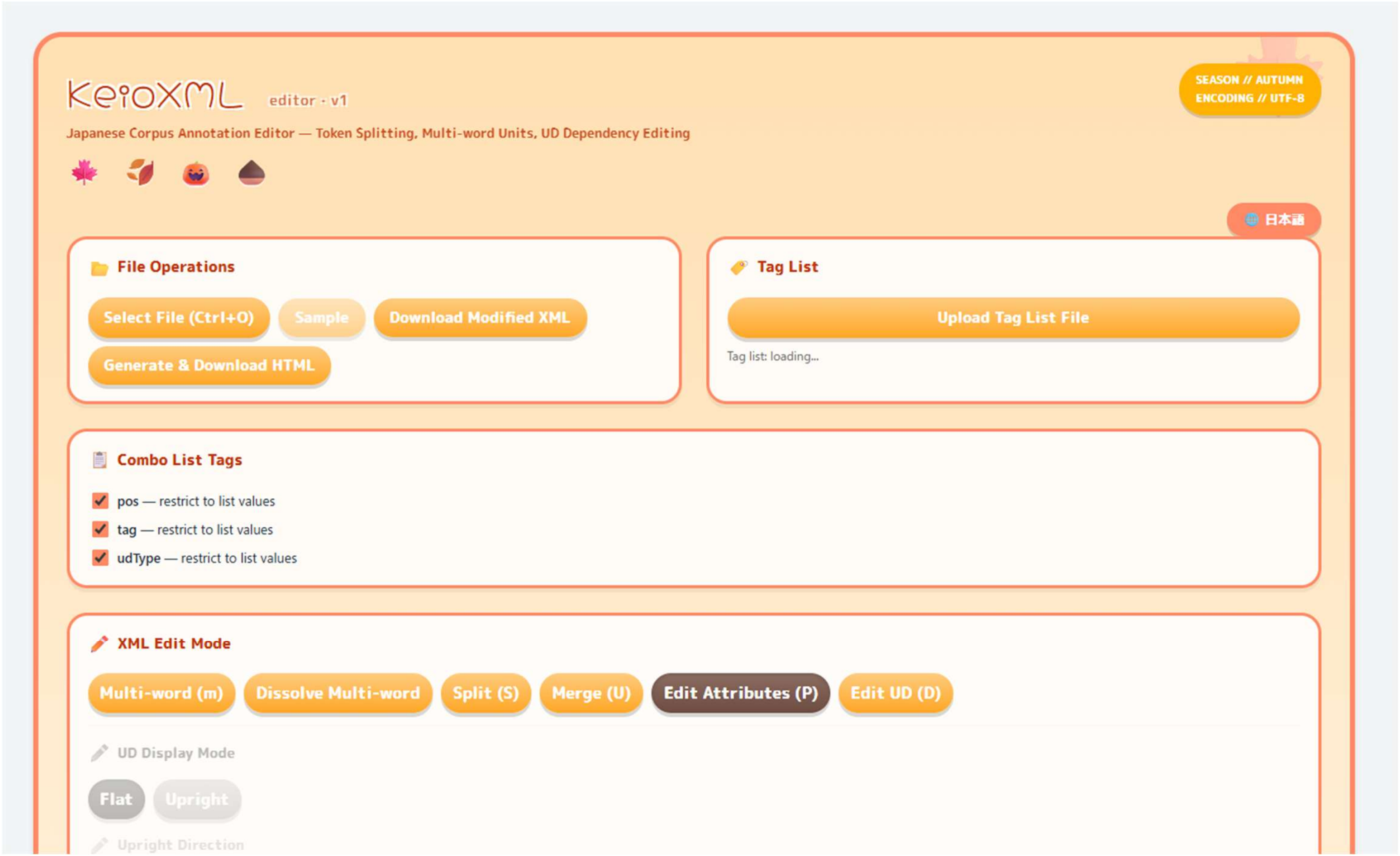
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a. Some lack the use in (ii):
**died people, happened accidents*
b. Errors do not occur in a stative sentence.
c. Errors with already stative pps.

KeioXLM editor



Adjective

Words that describe nouns · JJ JJR JJS

JJ — Adjective or ordinal numeral

e.g. third, ill-mannered, pre-war, regrettable, oiled, calamitous, first, separable, ectoplasmic, fourth, multilingual ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
She has a  red car .
PRP VBZ DT JJ  NN  .
```

JJR — Adjective: comparative

e.g. bleaker, braver, breezier, briefer, brighter, brisker, broader, busier, calmer, cheaper, cleaner, closer, colder ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
This is  bigger than that .
DT   VBZ JJR    IN   DT   .
```

JJS — Adjective: superlative

e.g. calmest, cheapest, choicest, classiest, cleanest, clearest, closest, commonest, darkest, deadliest, deepest ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
She is  the tallest player .
PRP VBZ DT  JJS     NN     .
```

Adverb

Words that modify verbs, adjectives and other adverbs · RB RBR RBS

RB Adverb

e.g. occasionally, unabatingly, maddeningly, adventurously, professedly, prominently, technologically, swiftly, fiscally ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
He  runs very quickly .
PRP VBZ  RB   RB      .
```

RBR Adverb: comparative

e.g. further, gloomier, grander, greater, harder, harsher, healthier, higher, larger, later, longer, louder, lower, more ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
She runs faster than me  .
PRP VBZ  RBR    IN   PRP .
```

RBS Adverb: superlative

e.g. best, biggest, earliest, farthest, first, furthest, hardest, highest, largest, least, most, nearest, tightest, worst

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
He  works hardest .
PRP VBZ   RBS     .
```

Practice 2

Adjectives & Adverbs · Click to reveal the hidden words and their tags

1

A	tall	man	walked	slowly	.
DT	?	NN	VBD	?	.

2

This	bag	is	cheaper	than	that	one	.
DT	NN	VBZ	?	IN	DT	NN	.

3

He	is	the	youngest	player	.
PRP	VBZ	DT	?	NN	.

4

Tom	runs	faster	than	Ken	.
NNP	VBZ	?	IN	NNP	.

5

The	soup	is	very	hot	.
DT	NN	VBZ	?	?	.

6

She	works	hardest	.
PRP	VBZ	?	.

Pronoun & Possessive

Words that stand in for, or belong to, nouns · PRP PRP$ POS

PRP — Personal pronoun

e.g. hers, herself, him, himself, it, itself, me, myself, one, oneself, ours, ourselves, she, them, themselves, they, us

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
She gave him a  gift .
PRP VBD  PRP DT NN   .
```

PRP$ — Possessive pronoun

e.g. her, his, mine, my, our, ours, their, thy, your

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
He  loves his  dog .
PRP VBZ   PRP$ NN  .
```

POS — Possessive ending

e.g. ', 's

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
John 's  car is  red .
NNP  POS NN  VBZ JJ  .
```

Determiner & Number

Words that introduce or quantify nouns · DT PDT CD

DT — Determiner

e.g. all, an, another, any, each, either, every, no, some, this/that, the, these/ those

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

The	cat	sat	on	a	mat	.
DT	NN	VBD	IN	DT	NN	.

PDT — Predeterminer

e.g. all, both, half, many, quite, such

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

All	the	students	passed	.
PDT	DT	NNS	VBD	.

CD — Cardinal number

e.g. mid-1890, nine-thirty, forty-two, one-tenth, ten million, 0.5, one, 1987, twenty, '79, zero, IX, '60s, .025, dozen ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

She	bought	three	apples	.
PRP	VBD	CD	NNS	.

Wh-words

Question and relative words · WDT WP WP$ WRB

WDT — Wh-determiner

e.g. what, whatever, which, whichever

```
The book which I    read .
DT  NN   WDT   PRP VBD  .
```

WP — Wh-pronoun

e.g. what, whatever, whatsoever, which, who, whom, whosoever

```
Who called you ?
WP  VBD    PRP .
```

WP$ — Possessive wh-pronoun

e.g. whose

```
The boy whose cat sings left .
DT  NN   WP$   NN  VBZ   VBD  .
```

WRB — Wh-adverb

e.g. how, however, whence, whenever, where, whereby, whereever, wherein, whereof, why

```
Where do  you live ?
WRB   VBP PRP VB   .
```

Practice 3

Pronouns, Determiners & Wh-words · Click to reveal the hidden words and their tags

1

They	love	their	new	teacher	.
?	VBP	?	JJ	NN	.

2

All	the	students	brought	two	books	.
?	?	NNS	VBD	?	NNS	.

3

Mary	's	brother	gave	her	a	gift	.
NNP	?	NN	VBD	?	DT	NN	.

4

Who	knows	the	girl	whose	bag	is	red	?
?	VBZ	DT	NN	?	NN	VBZ	JJ	.

5

This	is	the	house	which	Jack	built	.
DT	VBZ	DT	NN	?	NNP	VBD	.

6

Where	did	you	buy	those	shoes	?
?	VBD	PRP	VB	?	NNS	.